



ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

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1. RESEARCH PROMOTION, ETHICS & FUNDING POLICY

1. Preamble

St. Ann's College for Women is committed to fostering a vibrant research culture that promotes academic excellence, innovation, and societal relevance. The institution provides a conducive environment for faculty and students to engage in research, pursue higher studies such as Ph.D., and undertake multidisciplinary and interdisciplinary projects.

This policy establishes a structured framework for research promotion, ethical practices, plagiarism prevention, and research funding. It is aligned with the guidelines of the University Grants Commission, accreditation requirements of the National Assessment and Accreditation Council, and the norms of the affiliating university.

As a private unaided affiliated women's college, the institution focuses on capacity building, faculty-led research, student research exposure, and collaborative initiatives, while adhering to university regulations.

2. Objectives

The policy aims to:

- Create a conducive research environment for faculty and students
- Promote faculty research, Ph.D. enrollment, and student research participation
- Encourage multidisciplinary and interdisciplinary research
- Ensure ethical research practices and academic integrity
- Prevent plagiarism and ensure originality
- Facilitate seed funding and external research grants
- Promote women-centric, community-based, and socially relevant research
- Enhance research output in terms of publications, projects, and collaborations

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All faculty members (permanent, temporary, and visiting)

- Undergraduate and postgraduate students undertaking research/project work
- Research activities conducted independently or in collaboration with institutions, industries, and NGOs
- Minor research projects, consultancy, surveys, and extension-linked research

4. Research Promotion and Development

4.1 Establishment of Research & Development (R&D) Cell

The College shall establish a Research & Development (R&D) Cell to promote, coordinate, and monitor research activities in line with institutional goals and regulatory requirements.

4.1.1 Composition

- Principal – Chairperson
- Senior Faculty – Coordinator
- Department-wise Research Coordinators
- IQAC Coordinator – Member
- External Expert (if required) – Advisory Member

4.1.2 Objectives of R&D Cell

- To create a conducive environment for enhanced research productivity
- To identify priority research areas and develop research clusters
- To mentor and train faculty and students in research methodology
- To promote ethical and quality research practices
- To encourage innovation, collaboration, and funding opportunities

4.1.3 Functions of R&D Cell

The R&D Cell shall:

- Facilitate and guide faculty in undertaking research projects
- Promote publication in peer-reviewed and UGC-CARE listed journals
- Encourage interdisciplinary and collaborative research
- Organize workshops, seminars, FDPs, and training programmes
- Support faculty in applying for minor and major research projects
- Develop linkages with industries, NGOs, and research organizations
- Provide guidance for student projects and research activities

- Promote participation in conferences, seminars, and symposia
- Facilitate market surveys, consultancy, and extension research
- Strengthen research infrastructure and resources

4.1.4 Roles and Responsibilities

- Recommend proposals for seed funding and research support
- Monitor ongoing research projects and outcomes
- Ensure compliance with research ethics and plagiarism norms
- Maintain records of publications, projects, and collaborations
- Coordinate with IQAC for NAAC documentation and reporting

4.1.5 Meetings and Documentation

- The Cell shall meet at least twice in an academic year
- Maintain Minutes of Meetings (MoM), Action Taken Reports (ATR), and Annual Reports
- Ensure proper documentation for NAAC/DVV verification

4.1.6 Reporting

- Submit periodic reports to the Principal and IQAC
- Present annual research report to the Governing Body

4.2 Research Culture

- Encourage faculty to undertake research projects and Ph.D. programmes
- Promote student research through projects, field work, and internships
- Focus on women empowerment, local issues, and community development

4.3 Capacity Building

- Conduct Workshops/FDPs on research methodology, IPR, and publication ethics
- Provide training in academic writing and proposal development
- Deputation of faculty to seminars, conferences, and symposia

4.4 Incentives and Recognition

- Provide incentives for:
 - Publications in reputed journals
 - Conference presentations
 - Funded research projects

- Financial assistance for publication and participation in academic events
- Recognition through awards and performance appraisal systems

5. Research Ethics and Plagiarism Prevention

5.1 Ethical Standards

- Research shall adhere to honesty, integrity, and transparency
- Strict prohibition of:
 - Data fabrication and falsification
 - Plagiarism and unethical authorship

5.2 Plagiarism Policy

- Mandatory plagiarism check for:
 - Faculty publications
 - Student projects/dissertations
- Compliance with UGC-prescribed similarity index norms
- Use of standard plagiarism detection tools

5.3 Institutional Mechanism

- Constitution of:
 - Research Ethics Committee (REC)
 - Plagiarism Monitoring Committee
- Violations shall be dealt with as per UGC regulations and institutional rules

6. Seed Money and Research Funding

6.1 Institutional Seed Funding

- Provide **limited financial support** for initiating research
- Priority to:
 - Early-career faculty
 - Innovative and interdisciplinary research
 - Women-centric and community-based studies

6.2 External Funding Facilitation

- Encourage applications to:
 - University Grants Commission

- Department of Science and Technology
- Indian Council of Social Science Research
- Department of Biotechnology
- Provide support for **proposal writing and submission**

6.3 Utilization and Monitoring

- Funds shall be utilized strictly for approved purposes
- Submission of progress reports and utilization certificates
- Internal audit and monitoring by R&D Cell

7. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

- Promote patents, copyrights, and publications
- Conduct awareness programs on IPR
- Ownership and revenue sharing as per institutional and affiliating university norms

8. Roles and Responsibilities

8.1 Management & Principal

- Approve policy and ensure effective implementation

8.2 IQAC

- Monitor quality benchmarks and NAAC compliance
- Maintain documentation and evidence

8.3 R&D Cell

- Plan, coordinate, and monitor research activities

8.4 Faculty

- Undertake ethical research and guide student projects

8.5 Committees

- Ensure compliance with ethics and plagiarism norms

9. Monitoring and Review

- Annual review of publications, projects, and funding
- Submission of reports to IQAC and Governing Body
- Policy revision every three years or as per regulatory updates

10. Expected Outcomes

- Strengthened research culture
- Increased publications and funded projects
- Enhanced student research engagement
- Improved community-oriented and women-centric research

11. Documentation & Evidence

The institution shall maintain:

- R&D Cell Minutes and ATRs
- Seed funding records
- Plagiarism reports
- Publication proofs (UGC-CARE journals)
- Workshop/FDP reports
- MoUs and collaboration documents